

NHANES Dataset Summary

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Introduction

The National Health and Nutrition Examination Survey (NHANES) collects information on the health and nutritional status of the population. This report provides a brief description of the cleaned NHANES dataset used in this analysis, focusing on sample size, gender, ethnicity, and systolic blood pressure across the three survey waves.

Sample Characteristics

Sample size decreased across the three waves, from 10,175 participants in 2015 to 9,254 in 2017. The gender distribution remained very similar across waves, with males accounting for approximately 49% of participants in each wave. The ethnic composition of the sample varied across waves. White participants represented the largest group in each wave, although their proportion decreased from 36.1% in 2015 to 34.0% in 2017. The proportions of several other groups also changed across the three waves, illustrating differences in the composition of the samples over time. Average systolic blood pressure increased across the three waves. Mean average SBP increased from approximately 118 mm Hg in 2015 to 122 mm Hg in 2017, while the median increased from 115 to 118 mm Hg. The standard deviation also increased, suggesting somewhat greater variability in average SBP in 2017.

Table 1: Sample Characteristics by NHANES Wave

Wave	Sample Size	Male, n (%)
2015	10175	5003 (49.2%)
2016	9971	4892 (49.1%)
2017	9254	4557 (49.2%)

Table 2: Ethnicity Distribution by NHANES Wave

Wave	Ethnicity	n (%)
2015	Asian	1074 (10.6%)
2015	Black	2267 (22.3%)
2015	Mexican	1730 (17%)
2015	Other	470 (4.6%)
2015	Other Hispanic	960 (9.4%)
2015	White	3674 (36.1%)
2016	Asian	1042 (10.5%)
2016	Black	2129 (21.4%)
2016	Mexican	1921 (19.3%)
2016	Other	505 (5.1%)
2016	Other Hispanic	1308 (13.1%)
2016	White	3066 (30.7%)
2017	Asian	1168 (12.6%)
2017	Black	2115 (22.9%)
2017	Mexican	1367 (14.8%)
2017	Other	634 (6.9%)
2017	Other Hispanic	820 (8.9%)
2017	White	3150 (34%)

Table 3: Summary of Average Systolic Blood Pressure by NHANES Wave

Wave	Minimum	Maximum	Median	Mean	SD
2015	64.7	228.7	115.3	118.3	18.1
2016	74.0	231.3	117.3	120.4	18.4
2017	72.7	234.0	118.0	121.7	20.3